

DAY 13: TRIM YOUR CABLE BILL

Although I wouldn't go so far as to label myself a TV addict, binge watching a dramatic series is definitely one of my favorite ways to wind down at night. It gives me a chance to leave all the stress of work behind, and get wrapped up in another character's sometimes dysfunctional lifestyle. Seriously, what's not to love about that?

In NY, the perks of Joseph's cable TV job gave us access to every single channel for FREE—and wow, did I take that for granted! Reality hit when we moved to Florida and decided not to get cable right away. We thought it smart to let our finances settle down a bit with the relocation and new job, and bought a digital receiver to grab a few local channels.

Well, three years later we still don't have cable. Sure, I miss the convenience of accessing certain channels, but the boost to our budget is something I haven't regretted since. Plus, the plethora of streaming options gives us the ability to watch our favorite shows *without* the \$100 monthly bill.

In fact, a market research company called the NPD Group did a study and found the average cable bill for Americans was \$123 in 2015.⁹ Crazy, right? That's over \$1,400 in the course of a year!

Even though TV is seen as more of a daily staple rather than an occasional luxury, I don't currently see cable providers backing down on their prices. And over the next few years, I can only imagine how many new services will pop up to take advantage of this financial opportunity. But that's also a good thing. More competition has the ability to drive prices down, and ensures the possibility of reducing this monthly expense from a hundred dollar one, to \$25 or less.

So whether you're ready to ditch cable altogether and explore a few alternative options, or just want ways to cut back on your monthly bill, all of these ideas will easily lower the amount you spend on television. And yes, they are perfectly legal too!